A2 - Oral Mediation 4: Teacher's Notes

Before starting the mediation activity, ask students to read the task and the price list carefully to make the aim of the activity clear.

At the Market

You are spending Saturday morning visiting a local market with your English-speaking friend Sarah, who is visiting Spain for the first time. Sarah doesn't speak any Spanish and feels a bit nervous about shopping at the market. She wants to buy some fresh fruit and vegetables to cook a healthy dinner tonight, but she doesn't understand the prices, the special offers or what the vendor is saying. The vendor is speaking quickly in Spanish and using hand gestures, which is making Sarah more confused. You want to help Sarah understand the price list, so she can buy what she needs.



FRESH FRUIT & VEGETABLES



Apples
€2.50/kg



Bananas
€1.80/kg



Oranges
€2.00/kg



Tomatoes
€3.20/kg



Carrots
€1.50/kg



Cucumber
€2.80/kg



Lettuce
€1.20/kg



Peppers
€3.50/kg

SPECIAL OFFERS TODAY!

- **Buy 2 kg of any fruit → Get 10% discount**
- **Mixed vegetable bag (1 kg) → Only €5.00**

VENDOR'S RECOMMENDATIONS

Make your own salad:
FRESH TOMATOES
FRESH PEPPERS

Healthy snack:
SWEET APPLES

You have ten minutes to prepare the task. Your explanation should last between 2.30 to 3 minutes. You need to:

- Explain the prices and special offers to Sarah
- Tell Sarah what the vendor recommends
- Help Sarah decide what to buy

One of you will play the role of Sarah who is not sure about what to buy



In oral mediation, you need to understand the material (the price list) and then explain it in a clear and useful way. Read all the information carefully (prices, special offers and recommendations) and explain it in your own words using simple, friendly language.

Make sure it is clear why you are talking about the topic. Refer to the context (you are at the market helping your friend Sarah).

Refer to the price list you have been given, but do not read it aloud. Paraphrase the information and make it easy for your friend to understand.

Let's get ready!

In this section, you will help students to get ready for the task. First of all, they will learn what to do (Analyse the task) and later, they will work on the information (Analyse the information). You can give them the Learning Sequence worksheet to work on.

1. Analyse the task

Tell students they are going to think about the receiver of the message, the reason for the message and the information included. This will help them to use the proper register (formal or informal).

a. Read the task carefully and answer these questions. They will help you choose the register of the mediation task.

a) Who is going to be talking and who will receive the message?
You will be talking and your friend Sarah will receive the message.

b) Why does Sarah need your help?
Sarah doesn't speak Spanish. She feels nervous about shopping at the market and she doesn't understand the prices, special offers or what the vendor is saying.

c) What information does Sarah need to understand?
Sarah needs to understand the prices of the fruit and vegetables, the special offers available, the vendor's recommendations and which products are good for making a healthy dinner or as a healthy snack.

b. After analysing the task, choose the correct answer.

a) In this mediation task, I have to use formal / informal register.

b) The addressee is the person who sends / receives the message.

c) I have to give Sarah all the information she needs / only the prices.

2. Analyse the information

Now tell students to think about the relevant information on the price list they will have to use.

Read the information on the price list carefully.

a) What is the important information on the price list that your friend Sarah needs to know?

The important information on the price list includes the individual prices of each fruit and vegetable, the special offers (*10% discount when buying 2 kg of fruit, and the mixed vegetable bag (1 kg) for €5*) and the vendor's recommendations about which products are fresh and good for specific purposes (*tomatoes and peppers for salads, sweet apples for snacks*).

b) Underline the ideas that you think can be most helpful to explain to Sarah and help her buy the best products.

Accept all logical answers. Students should focus on: the most affordable options (carrots, lettuce, bananas), the special offers that help save money and the vendor's recommendations about freshness and products suitable for making a healthy meal.

Let's prepare the language!

In this section, students will learn structures and language suitable for the task.

1. Discuss the main ideas

1. Read this text where a person is explaining prices and recommendations at a market. Underline all the expressions he or she uses to talk about prices and give suggestions.

I went to the market yesterday. I found some good things to buy. The apples cost €2.50 per kilo. This is a good price. The vendor told me the tomatoes were very fresh, so I bought some. There was a special offer: buy two kilos of fruit and get a discount. I think this is a good way to save money. The vendor told me to try the peppers. They are good for salads. I bought some carrots, too. They were cheap – only €1.50 per kilo. I think it is better to buy vegetables when they are in season. They are fresher and cheaper.

Other Useful Language

It's €… per kilo / unit
It's a good idea to …
Why don't you … ?
There's a discount
There's a special offer
fresh / cheap

Do not use the same expressions all the time. Add new words to your vocabulary and you will see that you express yourself a lot better.



2. Imagine you have to explain several things. Put the following words in the order they should be used.

Finally First Then

1. First 2. Then 3. Finally

2. Give reasons and examples

1. Give a reason and an example that support each of the statements below.

a) I think you should buy the mixed vegetable bag.
It's a good price. You get one kilo of different vegetables for only €5. This is cheaper than buying them individually.
You get different vegetables in one bag. You can make a healthy and tasty dinner.

b) The tomatoes are a good choice today.
The vendor says they are very fresh today. They are really good for salads.
As they are fresh, they will taste good now and you can keep them longer.

Let's mediate!

Make sure students understand the task and you can summarise the tips below.

You are spending Saturday morning visiting a local market with your English-speaking friend Sarah, who is visiting Spain for the first time. Sarah doesn't speak any Spanish and feels a bit nervous about shopping at the market. She wants to buy some fresh fruit and vegetables to cook a healthy dinner tonight, but she doesn't understand the prices, the special offers or what the vendor is saying. The vendor is speaking quickly in Spanish and using hand gestures, which is making Sarah more confused. You want to help Sarah understand the price list, so she can buy what she needs.

1. Content

Content

Look at the price list on page 1 and read the information there carefully again. Select the information you are going to tell your friend Sarah.
You can use the following questions:

- Which products have the best prices and which ones are more expensive?

Best prices (cheapest):	**More expensive:**
Lettuce – €1.20/kg (cheapest)	Peppers – €3.50/kg (most expensive)
Carrots – €1.50/kg	Tomatoes – €3.20/kg
Bananas – €1.80/kg	Cucumbers – €2.80/kg
Oranges – €2.00/kg	Apples – €2.50/kg

- How can Sarah save money with the special offers?
  Sarah can save money in two ways:
  Buy 2 kg of any fruit → Get a 10% discount
  Buy the mixed vegetable bag (1 kg) → Only €5.00 (cheaper than buying vegetables separately)
- What products would be good for making a healthy dinner?
  Tomatoes – very fresh today, perfect for salads
  Peppers – very fresh today, perfect for salads
  Lettuce – good for salads (affordable option)
  Carrots – healthy vegetable option
  The mixed vegetable bag – convenient, has variety for cooking

2. Language

Language

Use your own words. Simplify or paraphrase the information.

Remember to adapt your register to the task and addressee.

Vary the language you use. Look at the Other Useful Language on page 3.

Use expressions to talk about prices, give recommendations and explain offers.

Refer students to the task again and tell them to pay special attention to the Quick Tip. Make sure that the students read the rubric, so that they know what is important.

Let's evaluate!
Rubrics for assessment

Oral Mediation

	Excellent	Good	Acceptable	Unsuitable
Clarity	The information is clear and easy to follow. The main points are clear.	The information is clear to follow, but sometimes it is not easy to understand what the main points are.	Some of the information selected is not relevant, lacks coherence and may include contradictions.	The information selected is not relevant, not clear, not easy to follow and includes contradictions.
Relevancy and processing	The student has summarised and paraphrased the main ideas without copying literally. No information has been added.	The student has summarised the main ideas, but has not paraphrased them. No information has been added.	The student conveys some appropriate information by summarising the main ideas, but not all.	The student doesn't convey much appropriate information, or has copied it from the text. Extra information may have been added.
Flow	The student speaks confidently without many pauses. The speech is fluent.	The student mostly speaks confidently without many pauses. The speech is fluent.	The student speaks confidently part of the time with several pauses. The speech is not always fluent.	The student doesn't speak confidently and often pauses. The speech is not fluent.
Vocabulary	The student uses a wide rage of appropriate vocabulary.	The student mostly uses appropriate and varied vocabulary.	The student uses appropriate vocabulary, but it is not varied.	The student doesn't use varied vocabulary, or is not able to paraphrase.
Grammar	The student uses a wide range of correct grammatical structures.	The student uses a wide range of grammatical structures, but not always correctly.	The student uses basic, but correct, grammatical structures.	The student uses basic grammatical structures, but not always correctly.
Pronunciation and intonation	The student uses understandable pronunciation and intonation.	The student mostly uses understandable pronunciation and intonation.	The student uses understandable pronunciation and intonation with a strong foreign accent.	The student doesn't use understandable pronunciation and intonation.

ADDITIONAL TEACHING TIPS:

Before the activity:

- Review vocabulary related to fruit, vegetables and prices
- Practise expressions for giving recommendations
- Review how to talk about discounts and special offers
- Practise currency and numbers in English

During preparation:

- Encourage students to take notes, but not write full sentences
- Remind them to paraphrase, not read
- Have them practise with connectors to organise information
- Suggest they plan who will be the friend asking questions

Role distribution:

- Student A: Mediator (explains prices, offers, recommendations)
- Student B: English-speaking friend (asks questions, expresses doubts, makes decisions)

Common mistakes to watch for:

- Reading prices directly from the list instead of paraphrasing
- Not explaining the special offers clearly
- Forgetting to mention the vendor's recommendations
- Using formal language instead of informal / friendly tone
- Not responding naturally to the friend's questions